

come they will), they will first take over the classic male jobs—stuff that requires “intellect”—like programming. Machine intelligence is going to replace male intelligence, leaving the latter sitting in front of the idiot box drinking beer in a world of automation. (Wait... was this supposed to be bad news?)

Safer in this Rise of the Machines will be people in professions that require “soft skills”—Public Relations, Human Resources, Nursing, and so on—professions traditionally female in nature.

While the impression is quite clear—that the Pearson creature lives in the Stone Age and can generalize cacti and roses and call them the same—there is perhaps some reasoning here. Machines will, no doubt, automate mundane tasks in industries like manufacturing (something they’ve been up to already)—tasks that, statistically, more men do than women. It isn’t going to be that easy for women, either. Less Human

Geek Dreams!

July was certainly entertaining! We got the Xbox 360 for an exclusive review, and boy were people fighting to be the one to review it. Nimish (fatbeing) won the battle, but was perhaps wishing he hadn’t. Everytime he sat down to play with the Xbox 360, something or the other came up, and our editor Deepak whisked him away for some work—leaving the rest of us laughing away to glory. Multiplayer racing was the highlight for the next week.

If the 360 wasn’t enough, we finally got our hands on the Intel Conroe as well. Michael was the lucky one chosen to test this monster. He’s already applied for a personal loan to buy it!

We have a new writer on board as well: Samir, who joined us this month, was a little taken aback

at first with all our craziness. In all fairness, it is a little hard to walk in the first day when the *Digit* team is in “issue-closing” mode. If all the gaming and screaming of expletives (when a race on the Xbox is lost) is not overwhelming enough, being told by the editor that you have 4 stories this month, and just three days in which to submit them, should do the trick.

To his credit, he took it well, and as we write this, is getting pointers on how to powerslide in *Project Gotham Racing* and which buttons do what for the Xbox 360. We think he’ll fit right in!

Oh, and we should tell you that our Editor officially hates the Xbox 360—because at least four writers missed their deadlines because of it. He’s probably going to be the only one happy to see it go!

DIGIT DIARY

Resources naturally translates to less Human Resource Managers, so really, nobody’s safe. The EU, apparently, is worried about this Impending Doom—nobody wants to see a bunch of unemployed men running about. They have, though, maintained an icy front and perhaps

Pearson would argue that they’re just acting tough.

Right now, though, the statistics poke holes in what would otherwise be a cheesy yet enjoyable “apocalyptic future” movie—while manufacturing jobs have indeed been decreasing, jobs in the services sector

all over the world are increasing for both men and women. What about the future, though? Well, seeing as how we’re going to have more time on our hands, we could orchestrate elaborate plans to overthrow the little buggers and claim our jobs back. ■

Blog WATCH

The revamped, Digg-like Netscape, as well as Firefox, are popular topics of current discussion. The Mac Pro, too, figures in this month’s list of blog picks

Michael Arrington

<http://snipurl.com/augt2> (www.techcrunch.com/2006/07/19/huge-red-flag-at-netscape/)

Huge Red Flag at Netscape

Netscape, which recently relaunched as a Digg-clone, wants to pay those top users to switch over to them. Jason Calacanis, who runs the Netscape property, wrote a post earlier today offering to pay top Digg users \$1,000 a month or more to switch to Netscape and submit news there instead.

I have a couple of observations on this. Netscape has a massively larger audience than Digg, but has absolutely failed to impact Digg growth at all...

Jeff Jarvis

<http://snipurl.com/blogaug5> (www.buzzmachine.com/index.php/2006/06/22/the-adman-and-the-ice-age/)

The adman and the ice age

Well, actually, I think the internet is potentially the most capitalistic force yet invented, empowering the individual and the small business to control their fates and their value.

It seems that Sorrell is defining capitalism as buying up ever more companies, since that’s what he does. But that, I say, is not the essence of the free economy. The individualistic anarchy—the free marketplace—of the internet is much purer.

The internet is not a socialist collective. That’s not to say that we do not end up acting in collective ways. The internet enables societies to form as well, even when they don’t know it—that is, when the data about our activities shows, after the fact, that great minds think alike. Still, the wired are not pinkos.

Chris Messina

<http://snipurl.com/blogaug6> (<http://factoryjoe.com/blog/2006/07/13/browsers-the-future-thereof/>)

I don’t get where Firefox is going. I don’t think it’s going anywhere actually. I think it’s strong, it’s stable, it’s a great platform. But it’s not innovative. It was a response to IE and now IE7 will come out, co-opt everything that makes Firefox great or interesting...

Tanya Klowden

<http://snipurl.com/blogaug4> (<http://arstechnica.com/journals/apple.ars/2006/7/1/4622>)

Mac Pros likely to sport Woodcrest, possibly Conroe as well

Intel’s had a busy summer, pushing highly anticipated chips out like they were new iPod models, and while those chips are certainly off to do some terribly interesting things in interesting little boxes, some of those chips are destined to live life inside a Mac. The only problem? We don’t know for certain which chips they are, yet!